

TIP SHEET: Do Not Resuscitate (DNR) Orders

Key Points

- Resuscitative efforts must be performed unless there is a valid DNR or DNR with Exceptions order in the patient's chart.
 - A DNR does not govern any situation outside of a cardiac arrest. In other words, a DNR order applies only during cardiac arrest. A Do Not Intubate (DNI) order applies outside of cardiac arrest and reflects a decision to withhold life-sustaining treatment. If a patient has only a DNI order without a DNR order and experiences cardiac arrest, the care team will initiate ACLS without intubation, honoring both directives.
 - Only the patient's Attending Physician (or resident with Attending oversight) may enter or cancel a DNR.
 - No verbal DNR orders are accepted (except rescinding or specific hospice transition scenarios).
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Types of Orders

- DNR: No CPR, no intubation, no defibrillation, no resuscitation meds.
 - DNR with Exceptions: Patient declines some, but not all, resuscitative measures — follow specifics exactly.
 - DNI: Do not intubate
 - Allow Natural Death (AND): Same meaning — used on downtime paper forms.
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Who Can Request a DNR?

- Capacitated patients: May verbally or non-verbally request.
 - Surrogate/Proxy/POA: Can request if patient is incapacitated — must reflect patient's wishes.
 - Guardians:
 - Court-appointed family guardians: May consent.
 - Professional or public guardians: Must obtain a court order first.
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Purple DNR Wristband

- Worn only by full DNR patients — not for DNR with Exceptions.
 - Two RNs must verify order and apply band.
 - Check wristband and DNR order at every shift change.
 - If rescinded or changed to Exceptions, remove band immediately.
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Special Situations

- Surgery: The surgical and anesthesia teams must re-discuss DNR status pre-op.
 - Hospice Admission: DNR must be re-entered on admission.
 - Yellow State DNR Form (DH Form 1896): Applies primarily in the prehospital setting. Honored in the ED or shortly after admission, must be reassessed as soon as feasible. Verify it is valid and signed – must be printed on yellow paper, including if copied.
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Rescinding a DNR

- May be rescinded any time by the patient or Surrogate/Proxy/POA (if consistent with patient's wishes).
 - Physician must cancel order, and wristband must be removed immediately.
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Documentation Reminders

- For incapacitated patients:
 - 2 physicians (one must be an Attending) must document terminal, end-stage, or vegetative state AND incapacity.
 - Both notes must be entered before the DNR order is placed.
 - Notes do not have to be written on the same date as the order but must be written prior to DNR order.
 - For patients with capacity:
 - 1 physician (Attending Physician, or his/her resident) shall document the request and enter a DNR order in the patient's record. A resident is expected to confer with the capacitated patient's Attending Physician prior to entering a DNR order. If the capacitated patient requests a DNR order, there is no requirement for two physicians to examine and document findings of specific conditions.
 - The primary Attending/team is primarily responsible for DNR notes.
 - DNR orders expire at discharge. Remove wristband and discuss advance directives with patient/family.
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When in Doubt

- Use Chain of Command if there is any conflict.
 - Contact Legal Services, Ethics Committee, or Case Management for help with complex cases.
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Quick Links

- UF Health Advance Directives Guide: [\[link\]](#)
- DNR Policy [\[link\]](#)
- Withdrawal of Life Support Policy [\[link\]](#)
- Florida DNR Form: [\[link\]](#)

- Hospice in Place Tip Sheet (to be performed by primary team) [link]

Recommendations:

- Update section III. C (...A physician (Attending or resident) may enter a DNR order...) to include fellows.
- When two notes required, pursue allowing APPs to enter one of the DNR notes supported by state law and national regulatory bodies.
 - Florida statutes for PAs (Chapter 458 (Physicians), § 458.347:
<https://flsenate.gov/Laws/Statutes/2021/0458.347>
 - Florida statutes for APRNs (§ 464.0123):
http://www.leg.state.fl.us/statutes/index.cfm?App_mode=Display_Statute&Search_String=&URL=0400-0499/0464/Sections/0464.0123.html
 - Florida DNR form: https://www.floridahealth.gov/about/patient-rights-and-safety/do-not-resuscitate/_documents/dnro.pdf
- Update EPIC criteria: If two notes are appropriately documented, an APP should be able to enter the order in EPIC.